Permissions and approval, in code

AI agents · Level 4 · Lesson 2



Today we will

- Give every tool a permission level.
- Explain why approval is checked in code, not left to the model.
- Read an audit log of actions.

Remember

- Read only, ask first, allowed, or not a tool at all.
- A model’s “I’ll ask” is learned and can fail; the code check doesn’t guess.
- Log every action: what, who approved, when, and what was blocked.

Approval drill

1. Warm-up (5 min): Who must sign before a school trip?
2. Teach (8 min): Permission levels and the check in code.
3. Drill (15 min): Agent, Code check, Approver, Log keeper.
4. Debrief (8 min): What did the check stop?
5. Wrap-up (4 min): Read the log, then the exit ticket.

Prepare about ten action cards, including one trick card that only says “Yes, send it”, the permissions table on the board, and green slips. No phones are needed.

Let’s discuss

1. Which actions at our school should never be tools for an agent?
2. Why must a yes be for one exact action, not for “anything”?
3. Who should read an agent’s log, and how often?

Exit ticket

- Write three tools and the permission level you would give each one, with a reason.